

Final Research Proposal

Assignment & Rubric

Portfolio context: This culminating assignment brings together the scaffolded research-design and writing activities completed throughout the course. Students revise earlier components using instructor feedback and integrate them into a complete APA-style research proposal.

Assignment Overview

Point value: 80 points

This assignment brings together all the work you have completed so far into a final research proposal.

Supporting Course Resources

- Lecture: Final Research Proposal
- Lecture: APA In-Text Citation
- Lecture: APA References & Citations
- Lecture: APA Style/Writing Guidelines

Instructions

- Students were provided with two example research proposals in Canvas.
- Revise your Introduction based on feedback from the Introduction Assignment. Use the feedback you received to strengthen your introduction.
- Expand your Method Outline to complete the full proposal based on the feedback.

Method Section

Your Method section should provide enough detail for another researcher to replicate your study. Follow APA format and consult your APA manual for structure and style.

Minimum sections (you may include more)

Participants

- Who will participate in the study?
- How many participants? Aim for at least 40 per group, using similar studies as a guide.
- What sampling method will you use?
- How will you recruit them (e.g., flyers, online ads, community outreach)?
- What are the expected participant characteristics (e.g., age, gender, ethnicity)?
- Are there eligibility criteria (e.g., clinical diagnosis, experience level)?
- What will motivate participation? Specify compensation (e.g., course credit, gift card, treatment).

Materials

- Describe all materials used to measure or manipulate your variables. Explain your choices and provide citations.
- Ensure you address every variable in your hypotheses. Do not include unrelated measures.
- You do not need to provide full surveys or stimuli, but describe them in enough detail for the reader to visualize.
- Include any equipment, surveys, drugs, or stimuli used.

Procedure

- Specify your design (within-subjects or between-subjects).
- Detail each step of the participant experience from start to finish.
- Indicate study location (lab, field, online), duration, and participant instructions.
- Outline the study timeline, including the number of data collection points.
- Clarify incentives provided to participants.
- Address any ethical considerations, including consent and debriefing.

Formatting Reminders

- Write in future tense (this is a proposal).
- Use active voice.
- Justify your design choices and explain how they support your hypotheses.
- Use appropriate terminology to demonstrate mastery of course material.

Finalize and Format Your Proposal

When you've completed your Method section and revised your Introduction, carefully review APA guidelines to ensure proper formatting.

Your final paper must include:

- An APA-style title page
- A fully written and edited introduction
- A fully written method section
- A reference page with at least five primary sources (one must be your springboard article)

Optional: tables or figures (APA-compliant) and extra credit.

Be sure your final paper follows the guidelines and expectations outlined in the description and rubric.

Final Proposal Rubric

Total: 80 points

Title Page - 4 points		Points
Full Marks	Contains all components	4
Partial Marks	Missing some components	2
No Marks	Missing many components or missing entirely	0

Statement of the Importance of the Problem. - 4 points		Points
Criterion description	What is the research problem & why is this research important to do? Possible implications. This is usually related to the DV. This should be supported by at least 1 source.	
Full Marks	Clear and supported argument and identification of real-world issue.	4
Partial Marks	Identified a problem but importance is weakly identified, typically no support or gaps in reasoning.	3
Partial Marks	Identified problem but it is stating the hypothesis instead of a real-world issue	2
No Marks	Weak identification of research problem and little or no argument for importance.	0

Well-developed Introduction. - 18 points		Points
Criterion description	Used relevant scientific sources to build up to and support the hypothesis, methodology and choice of participants.	
Full Marks	Provides strong supporting evidence of previous research and connects logically to current study. Reader can predict hypothesis by the end of the paper before being stated.	18
Partial Marks	Provides strong evidence but weak connection to current study.	17
Partial Marks	Related studies but provide weak evidence that does not connect to hypothesis and methodology.	15
Partial Marks	Provides weak supporting evidence that may not connect to hypothesis OR Inappropriate choice of methodology.	15
Partial Marks	Peripherally related studies that offer no support to current study.	11
Partial Marks	Most research presented is not related to current study.	9
No Marks	Very little research is presented and research presented is not related to current study.	0

Testable Hypothesis - 4 points		Points
Criterion description	Clearly stated testable directional hypothesis that involves at least one independent variable and one dependent variable.	
Full Marks	Clearly stated testable directional hypothesis with at least one IV & one DV.	4
Partial Marks	Unclear or awkward or nondirectional testable hypothesis with at least one IV & one DV.	3
Partial Marks	Hypothesis is testable but IV or DV not clear.	2
No Marks	Untestable hypothesis.	0

Appropriate Participants - 4 points		Points
Criterion description	Clearly Identify and describe the participants, sample size, sampling method, compensation.	
Full Marks	Participants are appropriate for stated hypothesis. Participants' relevant demographic characteristics are identified (e.g., age, gender, ethnicity and any other relevant to study). Sample size is identified and sampling/recruiting methods identified and compensation.	4
No Marks	1 point will be deducted for each missing requirement.	0

Dependent Variable - 6 points		Points
Criterion description	Selected an appropriate DV to test hypothesis. Clearly describes how DV(s) would be measured. Specific Information about DVs(e.g., surveys, tests, and observational methods).	
Full Marks	Appropriate DV described in enough detail to allow for replication.	6
Partial Marks	Appropriate DV described with detail but not enough to allow for replication.	5
Partial Marks	Appropriate DV described but 2 or more critical elements are missing making it unclear (e.g., stimuli being presented or number of items on a test).	4
Partial Marks	Appropriate DV but description is vague with multiple missing elements.	3
No Marks	Appropriate DV but measure is unclear and inadequate OR Inappropriate DV.	0

Procedures - 6 points		Points
Criterion description	Clear and well-designed research design. The steps must be clearly identified. The IV(s) are clearly identified AND described. The procedure is adequate for the hypothesis (levels of IV should match the hypothesis).	
Full Marks	Appropriate procedures to test hypothesis with at least 2 levels of IV. Clear step-by- step description of procedures, enough detail to allow for replication.	6
Partial Marks	Appropriate procedures to test hypothesis with at least 2 levels of IV. Clear step-by- step description of procedures but not enough detail to allow for replication.	5
Partial Marks	Appropriate procedures to test hypothesis with at least 2 levels of IV. Provides some description of procedures but lack minor details or are confusing in some areas.	4
Partial Marks	Provide some description of procedures but lack multiple details OR Procedures to test hypothesis may be somewhat inappropriate (major logical flaws or limitations).	3
No Marks	Description of procedures is disorganized, incomprehensible, and/or lack substantial details OR Procedures to test hypothesis do not appear appropriate	0

Ethical Information - 2 points		Points
Full Marks	Includes all relevant ethical information- consent- debriefing etc.	2
Partial Marks	Missing some information	1
No Marks	Missing a lot of information or missing entirely	0

Sources - 5 points		Points
Criterion description	Utilized Springboard article and four other primary sources.	
Full Marks	Relevant citation for springboard article and reviews four other primary sources.	5
No Marks	Lose 1 point for each missing source.	0

Spelling, Grammar, Clarity - 7 points		Points
Criterion description	Well written, edited paper. Paper should have good flow and transitions. Paper length is typically 4-6 pages. 1 free grammar or spelling mistake will be allowed per page of text (not title or reference page).	
Full Marks	Good flow, nice transitions, information is clearly presented, and no more than 1 mistake per page.	7
Partial Marks	Mostly good flow, transitions, and most information is clearly presented. Noticeable improvements in style could be made, but no more than 1 mistake per page.	6
Partial Marks	Poor flow, transitions, and information is not clearly presented, but no more than 1 mistake per page	4
No Marks	Lose 1 point for each additional grammar or spelling error.	0

APA Style - 20 points		Points
Criterion description	APA style is correct for title page, text of Paper and Reference page	
Full Marks	Lose ½ point for each error. If make the same mistake consistently that was identified in the introduction you will lose ½ point for each time.	20
No Marks		0

Extra Credit - 0 points		Points
Criterion description	Identify at least 1 Potential Confounding variable	
Full Marks	Earn up to 2 points	0
No Marks		0

Deductions - 0 points		Points
Design	If design is not an experiment, you will lose 20 points.	0
Intorduction	If you did NOT remove Brief Introduction to Methods from introduction, you will lose 2 points.	0
Springboard	If your proposals does Not have relevant connection to springboard, you will lose 5 points.	0